

There are certain common elements that bind games in the genre of role-playing (RPGs such as *Diablo*), computers and console RPGs, massively multiplayer online games (MMORPGs such as *World of Warcraft*), puzzle adventures (*Limbo*, *Braid*), text adventures, action (*God of War*), first-person shooter (*Call of Duty* and *Crysis*) and casual mobile games (*Fruit Ninja* and *Angry Birds*):

- ▶ **Rules:** Rules clearly define possible and allowed actions of the players. Usually, the same rules apply to all players.
- ▶ **Interactivity and Player:** Games are player-centric and have lots of interactivity. They can be single player (*Solitaire*), player-versus-player (*Chess*), multiple players vs. the game system (*World of Warcraft* or *FarmVille* on Facebook.) etc.
- ▶ **Goals:** Every game has one or more goals without which interactivity is useless. Eliminating all opposing forces in *Counter-Strike* or killing pigs in *Angry Birds* are examples of goals.
- ▶ **Resources:** Resources can be anything under player control. These are given to the player at the start or during the game (maybe as rewards for playing better – some of which may be hidden at different levels.) The mushrooms and coins in *Mario* and various weapons in *Counter-Strike* are a few examples.
- ▶ **Struggle:** Struggle or conflict is introduced through opposition like enemies, non-player characters (NPCs) or puzzles depending upon the genre. The challenges involved make you play the game again and again. 📺



Player-versus-player example: Chess